

Activity Guide — senior / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 1 — Blind Smell-Test Identification

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Herbs — Auṣadhi through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

small samples of each of the six herbs, blindfolds (optional), notebook

What students do

Students close their eyes and try to identify each herb by smell. They record their guess + observation, then check.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.

- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Class Herb Identification Deck

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior

What you will do

Each student creates one identification card for one of the six herbs: Sanskrit/botanical name, leaf drawing, smell description, three traditional uses, one active compound, one safety note. Cards combined into class library.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a poster / model / digital deliverable).
- **Written reflection** (500 words (Senior)): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (5-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 3 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.